



NSS IITD

## **CONSTITUTION OF NSS IIT DELHI**

### **PREAMBLE**

We, the members of the National Service Scheme at the Indian Institute of Technology Delhi (NSS IITD), in order to foster an inclusive and diverse community, to promote social welfare, and to uphold the principles of equality and justice, do hereby adopt this gender-neutral constitution.

# **CHAPTER 1**

## **Terms of References and Objectives**

### TERMS OF REFERENCE

#### 1-A-1

The IIT Delhi chapter of the National Service Scheme (hereinafter referred to as NSS IITD or the Board) is institutionalised under the Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports, Government of India.

#### 1-A-2

NSS IITD shall incorporate the philosophy and objectives as laid down by the National Service Scheme, Government of India Manual, and shall be guided by the same philosophy in all its activities.

### OBJECTIVES

#### 1-B-1

The broad objectives of NSS IITD volunteers, in line with the NSS Manual of the Government of India and incorporating the new objectives set by the National Service Scheme (NSS), are as follows:

- a. Understand the community in which they work and strive to create a positive impact by addressing its needs and concerns.
- b. Develop a strong sense of social and civic responsibility among volunteers, encouraging them to actively engage with the community and foster a spirit of empathy and compassion.
- c. Identify the needs and problems of the community and actively involve community members in the problem-solving process, promoting participatory development.
- d. Utilise their knowledge, skills, and expertise to find practical solutions to individual and community problems, focusing on sustainable and inclusive development.
- e. Cultivate competence required for effective group living, teamwork, and shared responsibilities, fostering a collaborative and cohesive volunteer community.
- f. Gain skills in mobilising community participation, organising community events, and implementing social initiatives, strengthening their community engagement capabilities.
- g. Acquire leadership qualities and democratic attitudes, encouraging volunteers to take initiative, lead projects, and promote democratic decision-making.
- h. Develop the capacity to respond effectively to emergencies and natural disasters, preparing volunteers to play a crucial role in disaster management and relief efforts.
- i. Promote national integration and social harmony by embracing diversity, promoting intercultural understanding, and working towards a united and inclusive society.
- j. Aligned with the motto or watchword of National Service Scheme (NSS) – ‘NOT ME BUT YOU,’ inspiring NSS IITD volunteers to dedicate themselves to nation-building

activities through various events and projects aimed towards the betterment of people in and around IIT Delhi. The belief in such activities as a means of great satisfaction and joy shall be shared and cultivated among the volunteers.

- k. Embrace the new objectives set by the NSS and actively incorporate them into the activities and projects undertaken by NSS IITD, focusing on the development and well-being of the community at large.
- l. Engage in activities that promote environmental sustainability, health awareness, education, innovation, and societal progress, while aligning with the overarching goals of NSS as stipulated by the Government of India.
- m. Collaborate with various stakeholders, including other organisations, academic institutions, and government bodies, to create synergistic efforts towards community development and social welfare.
- n. Foster a culture of continuous learning, self-improvement, and skill development among volunteers, empowering them to become change-makers and leaders in their respective fields.
- o. Uphold the principles of ethical conduct, integrity, and respect for human rights in all activities, demonstrating commitment to ethical practices and responsible citizenship.
- p. Strive to measure and evaluate the impact of NSS IITD initiatives, using data-driven insights to enhance the effectiveness and efficiency of community service efforts.
- q. Embrace the principles of inclusivity and equal opportunity, promoting diversity and ensuring that the benefits of NSS IITD's activities are accessible to all members of the community, regardless of background or status.
- r. Collaborate with academic institutions and stakeholders to foster research, innovation, and sustainable solutions to social challenges, leveraging the knowledge and expertise within NSS IITD to address real-world problems effectively.
- s. Facilitate continuous engagement and communication with the community, understanding its evolving needs and aspirations, and adapting NSS IITD's activities accordingly to foster meaningful and sustainable impact.
- t. Strive for continuous improvement and evolution, adapting to changing social dynamics, technological advancements, and national priorities, to ensure the relevance and effectiveness of NSS IITD's initiatives over time.

#### 1-B-2

NSS IITD also offers a courses NSN100 and NSN102 to Undergraduate Students at IIT Delhi, and students can select NSS IITD and complete a certain number of hours (as specified by IIT Delhi in the Courses of Study of each batch) of social service under the supervision of NSS IITD as a degree requirement.

## **CHAPTER 2**

### **Composition of the NSS IITD and Tenure of its Office Bearers**

#### **COMPOSITION AND ELIGIBILITY**

##### **2-A-1**

NSS IITD, as an independent body, shall form a union with the institute's faculty and students as members for both planning and executing the events/activities with the help of the IITD community. It shall function as per the hierarchy mentioned below to ensure the smooth conduction of any NSS activity carried either within the IITD campus premises or outside the campus but organised under NSS IITD.

1. Faculty Coordinator, NSS IITD
  - Faculty at NSS IITD
2. Faculty Advisors for different domains of NSS IITD
3. General Secretary, NSS IITD
  - The number of General Secretaries will be decided by Coordinator NSS IITD, in consultation with immediate past General Secretaries
  - 4th Year or senior student at IIT Delhi
4. Immediate Past Coordinator, NSS IITD
5. Immediate past General Secretaries
6. Secretaries, NSS IITD
  - The number of Secretaries will be decided by the incumbent General Secretaries, in consultation with Coordinator NSS IITD
  - 3rd Year or senior student at IIT Delhi
7. A. Executive, NSS IITD
  - The number of Executives will be decided by the incumbent General Secretaries, in consultation with Coordinator NSS IITD
  - 2nd Year or senior student at IIT Delhi

B. Post Graduate Representatives

  - The number of Post Graduate Representatives will be decided by the incumbent General Secretaries, in consultation with Coordinator NSS IITD
  - Post Graduate student at IIT Delhi
8. All the students of IIT Delhi can be involved with projects of NSS IITD as Volunteers

#### **OFFICE BEARERS**

##### **2-B-1**

The NSS Faculty Coordinator shall play the role of a guide and a leader for the NSS Office and is appointed by Director IIT Delhi. The NSS Faculty in-charge drives the overall vision of NSS and encourages student involvement in various activities carried out by the board. The Co-ordinator will chair all meetings of NSS IITD.

## 2-B-2

- The General Secretary shall be Convener of all Board Meetings and shall have the authority to preside over discussions and decision-making processes.
- The General Secretary shall be responsible for all projects, activities, and collaborations of NSS IITD and shall have the absolute and final say in terminating any project, activity, or collaboration unless it is objected by the Coordinator NSS IITD.
- In case of misconduct, violation of the Honour Code or Code of Conduct, or inefficiency within the team, the General Secretary shall have the authority to penalise team members or volunteers after thorough investigation and consultation with the Coordinator NSS IITD.
- The General Secretary shall collaborate with other members of the NSS IITD board, stakeholders, and external organisations to foster effective project implementation and community engagement.
- The General Secretary shall ensure that all projects and activities undertaken by NSS IITD align with the objectives and principles of NSS, as well as the broader goals of community development and social welfare.
- The General Secretary shall maintain transparent and effective communication channels with all team members, volunteers, and stakeholders, encouraging active participation and feedback to improve the functioning of NSS IITD. The General Secretary shall have the authority to withhold certain information that they deem to be confidential.

## TERM OF OFFICE

### 2-C-1

The term of office of all the selected student members shall normally be one academic year, expiring on the day the new General Secretaries are appointed. In case the new team formation is delayed, the current team shall continue to hold office and all responsibilities.

### 2-C-2

The term of office of the Coordinator shall end only when a new Coordinator is appointed by Director IIT Delhi. In case of unavailability of Coordinator NSS IITD due to short leave or any other reason, the coordinator can designate the immediate past Co-ordinator or any of the faculty advisors as the signatory for all Board activities until the Coordinator NSS IITD is back.

## **CHAPTER 3**

### **Domain of Work**

#### **DOMAINS**

##### **3-A-1**

NSS IITD will have projects in the following 6 domains:

1. Education
2. Environment
3. Health
4. Innovation
5. Society
6. Miscellaneous

The Miscellaneous domain can have any projects that are in collaborations with other bodies or organisations.

##### **3-A-2**

All projects and events undertaken by NSS IITD shall be a part of any one or more domains as listed above. Faculty advisors can be appointed for the domains by Director IITD in consultation with Coordinator NSS IITD.

##### **3-A-3**

Introduction of new projects and/or project domains in NSS IITD or scrapping of old projects/domains can be done by General Secretaries NSS IITD in consultation with Coordinator NSS IITD.

#### **INTERNSHIP POLICY**

##### **3-B-1**

NSS IITD can float summer or winter internships in any of its ongoing projects.

##### **3-B-2**

NSS IITD can also collaborate with any external organisation working in the social domain to float summer and winter internships.

##### **3-B-3**

Self Arranged Internships: The students of IIT Delhi, as volunteers of NSS IITD, can take up an internship with any registered NGO/social-organisation in India, with prior permission from NSS IITD. The work should include mostly on-ground activities related to domains of NSS IITD.

#### 3-B-4

Any internship done without prior permission from NSS IITD would not be considered an activity under NSS IITD. A verification from the highest authority in the NGO with NSS IITD will be compulsory for prior approval, and the NGO should be registered with the Government of India or corresponding state governments and should have a working website.

#### 3-B-5

NSS IITD is not bound to issue separate certificates for internship.

## **CHAPTER 4**

### **Functions and Working**

#### **4-A-1**

NSS IITD will generate opportunities for students of IIT Delhi to volunteer in activities of social service and nation-building through community service.

#### **4-A-2**

The projects of NSS IITD shall be led by a team of Secretary, Executives and Post Graduate Representatives who will be responsible for overseeing the overall working, execution, and management of volunteers of respective projects.

#### **4-A-3**

The Board shall be responsible for the overall organisation of all its events and welfare activities and shall set guidelines for the same.

#### **4-A-4**

Monetary exchange as honorarium to external bodies/individuals as a speaker or for holding workshops or events shall be avoided.

#### **4-A-5**

The Article 4-A-4 can be superseded by Co-ordinator NSS IITD in consultation with General Secretaries NSS IITD if deemed fit in case of extraordinary situations or events.



## **CHAPTER 5**

### **Permanent Committee**

#### NSS MANAGERIAL COMMITTEE

##### 5-A-1

The NSS Managerial Committee shall be composed of:

1. Co-ordinator NSS IITD
2. General Secretaries
3. Faculty Advisors
4. All Secretaries of NSS IITD

##### 5-A-2

The NSS Managerial Committee meeting shall be convened at least once every semester by General Secretaries.

##### 5-A-3

The Managerial Committee shall coordinate all the activities of the board and review every activity of the board. It will evaluate the performance of the board in every sphere and come up with new ideas.

#### NSS ADMINISTRATIVE COMMITTEE

##### 5-B-1

The NSS Administrative Committee shall be composed of:

1. Coordinator NSS IITD
2. General Secretaries

##### 5-B-2

The Administrative Committee shall address any and every aspect pertaining to the Board, including, but not limited to, complaints against the board or any of its members.

##### 5-B-3

The Administrative Committee is authorised to take any and every decision pertaining to the Board.

## **CHAPTER 6**

### **Appointments and Removal**

#### **SELECTION**

##### **6-A-1**

The General Secretaries of NSS IITD will be selected by a panel composed of members of the NSS Administrative Committee. Special Invitees can be added to the panel by the NSS Administrative Committee.

##### **6-A-2**

The Secretaries, Executives, and Post Graduate Representatives of NSS IITD will be chosen by a panel comprising the NSS Administrative Committee and the General Secretaries Designate. Special Invitees can be added to the panel by the NSS Administrative Committee.

##### **6-A-3**

Being an NSS-registered student is not a mandatory requirement for holding a position in the NSS team.

#### **REMOVAL**

##### **6-B-1**

The NSS Coordinator, in consultation with General Secretaries, shall be responsible to remove any team member upon violation of the Honour Code and Code of Conduct or inefficiency in work.

## **CHAPTER 7**

### **Volunteering & Collaboration with NSS IITD**

#### **7-A-1**

All students of IIT Delhi are eligible to volunteer in activities of NSS IITD.

#### **7-A-2**

The volunteer selection for any regular volunteering project shall be done by the Secretary heading the project in consultation with Executives and Post Graduate Representatives involved in the said project.

### **VOLUNTEERING DUTIES**

#### **7-B-1**

The Volunteers of NSS IITD shall be responsible for the activity they are doing under a specific project, and regularity and diligence shall be expected from them towards the same.

#### **7-B-2**

The Volunteers of NSS IITD are representing NSS IITD in front of its stakeholders, and hence shall be expected to act professionally with decency. Any inappropriate or aggressive act shall be termed a violation of the Honour Code.

#### **7-B-3**

The Volunteers shall be expected to be regular in the projects, and continuous irregularity could invite strict action by NSS IITD.

### **COLLABORATIONS**

#### **7-C-1**

Any Collaboration with NSS IITD, hereby known as ‘the Collaborator’, would proceed only after an official Memorandum of Understanding has been drafted and signed by the competent authorities.

#### **7-C-2**

The direct interaction between the volunteer and the Collaborator is strictly prohibited. In case the organisation tries to engage with the volunteers directly without informing the NSS IITD team beforehand the Memorandum of Understanding will be nullified effective immediately.

#### 7-C-3

The Volunteer data is confidential and NSS IITD will not be liable to give any Volunteer information to the Collaborator. The volunteer information will remain with the NSS IITD team and they may share the information only if they think it is required and only after a formal approval from the General Secretaries.

#### 7-C-4

In a span of three running months, collaboration with any club shall not exceed a total of four non-ground hours. Any exceptions to this policy may be granted only after a review by the NSS administrative committee

## **CHAPTER 8**

### **Courses offered by NSS IITD**

8-A-1

NSS IITD floats non-graded courses NSN100 and NSN102 for all Undergraduate students in IIT Delhi.

8-A-2

The students registered for both the courses offered by NSS IIT Delhi should complete the number of hours, as specified in the Courses of Study of the respective batch, of social work under NSS IITD.

## **CHAPTER 9**

### **Hours Policy of NSN courses**

#### **9-A-1**

NSN course and an essential component of the degree requirement for Undergraduate students who have opted for NSS.

#### **9-A-2**

Classification of activities:

- a. Ground Events - The events/activities in which a Volunteer is at the delivering end and works on the ground and impacts the stakeholders directly.
- b. Non-Ground Events - The events/activities in which a Volunteer is at the receiving end in a lecture session/workshop/meeting/discussion.

#### **9-A-3**

The Course Guideline of NSN100 and NSN102 states that students have to complete a certain number of hours, as specified in the Courses of Study of the respective batch. The requirement of hours can increase as per rules for defaulters in Hours Policy of NSS IITD. The Hours Policy will be available on NSS IITD website ([nss.iitd.ac.in](http://nss.iitd.ac.in)) and shall be maintained by the NSS Administrative Committee.

#### **9-A-4**

NSS Volunteers are entitled to file an Hours Complaint through the NSS IITD website. NSS IITD will not be bound to entertain complaints regarding the hours for projects/events after 1 month of updating the hours of the same.

#### **9-A-5**

For all events, whether in collaboration with other organisations or solely held by NSS IITD, only those volunteers whose attendance has been taken by the members of NSS team will be awarded hours, unless stated otherwise in an official agreement.

9-A-6

NSS hours will be given only for the activities that are either conducted by NSS IITD or have been approved, before the event's conclusion, by the NSS Administrative Committee. The approved activities would be those which are floated through a mail by the mail ID of either the Faculty Coordinator or The General Secretary NSS IITD.

## **CHAPTER 10**

### **Feedback and Grievances**

10-A-1

All feedback or grievances with respect to the activities of NSS IITD can be directed to the NSS Coordinator or General Secretaries.

10-A-2

The General Secretaries shall be responsible to act on the grievances/complaints.

## **CHAPTER 11**

### **Certification Policy**

#### **NSN100 and NSN102 FOR UNDERGRADUATE STUDENTS**

##### **11-A-1**

All undergraduate students registered under NSS are expected to complete at least 80 hours of social service in accordance with Chapter 9 to receive an ‘S’ grade in NSN100. Out of these 80 hours, a student must complete at least 50 ‘Ground’ hours, with a maximum of 30 ‘Non-Ground’ hours.

Similarly, to receive an ‘S’ grade in NSN102, students must complete at least 40 hours of social service, including a minimum of 25 ‘Ground’ hours and a maximum of 15 ‘Non-Ground’ hours.

NSS-registered students can enroll in either course but are not allowed to take both.

##### **11-A-2**

In case of applicability of the penalty, the hours requirement will increase in accordance with the Hours Policy of NSS IITD as redirected in Chapter 9.

##### **11-A-3**

The IITD grade sheet with an ‘S’ grade for NSN course shall serve as sufficient proof that the bearer is a bona fide NSS volunteer at IIT Delhi. No additional certificate shall be issued for volunteering under normal circumstances. This grade sheet can also be used as proof for any external organization, confirming the student's participation in NSS activities as recorded in IIT Delhi’s NGU portal.

#### **NSS VOLUNTEERING FOR POSTGRADUATE STUDENTS**



#### 11-B-1

The Post Graduate Students shall be entitled to get Certification of acknowledgement as an NSS Volunteer upon their successful completion of 80 hours of NSS Volunteering, as mentioned in the Hours Policy of NSS IITD.

#### NSS IITD BEST VOLUNTEER

##### 11-C-1

NSS IITD shall confer annual awards of the NSS Best Volunteer.

##### 11-C-2

The NSS Managerial Committee will choose the Best Volunteers for the session among the applied participants.

#### NSS IITD EXCEPTIONAL VOLUNTEER

##### 11-D-1

Any IIT Delhi student who has volunteered for more than 240 hours in NSS, including a minimum of 200 hours of on-ground service, shall be eligible to receive the 'NSS IITD Exceptional Volunteer' certificate.

## **CHAPTER 12**

### **Honour Code**

#### 12-A-1

As NSS IITD being a body of prestige and importance, volunteers shall be given due respect and shall be expected to work only in activities for social welfare or getting exposure to social activities while working under the umbrella of NSS IITD.

#### 12-A-2

The NSS Team Members (Article 2-A-1) and Volunteers registered under NSS (Article 1-B-3) shall be expected to have decent behaviour when interacting with stakeholders and beneficiaries of NSS IITD, and any act against it or any unethical activity while representing NSS IITD, shall be deemed a violation of the Honour Code.

#### 12-A-3

Fraudulent Cases: An hours-penalty and strict action shall be taken if any fraudulent case of volunteering is found. Depending on the nature of the violation, the matter can be raised to the disciplinary Committee by the NSS Coordinator.

## **CHAPTER 13**

### **Protector of Constitution**

#### **13-A-1**

The NSS Administrative Committee (Article 5-B-1) shall be regarded as the protector of the Constitution.

#### **13-A-2**

Protectors of the constitution must see that all the activities of NSS IITD are carried out in accordance with the constitution and must address the complaints and grievances of the NSS volunteers.

#### **13-A-3**

The protector shall have the power to refer any case of Honour Code Violation to the Disciplinary Committee IITD for further Action.

## **CHAPTER 14**

### **Amendements in Constitution**

#### **14-A-1**

Any amendments in Chapter 1 and Chapter 14 shall require approval of Coordinator NSS IITD.

#### **14-A-2**

The chapters other than those mentioned in Article 14-A-1 can be amended by Coordinator NSS IITD in consultation with General Secretaries NSS IITD. An appendix has to be maintained for all amendments to the Constitution, since its inception.